



City Guide_beijing

3 Days in Beijing: The Perfect Couple's Itinerary

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3 Days in Beijing: The Perfect Couple's Itinerary

Beijing is one of the most romantic and exciting cities in China for couples. From ancient palaces to hidden hutong bars, this 3-day itinerary covers the best of Beijing -- with real addresses, metro stops, and prices.

Day 1: Imperial Beijing -- History & Romance

8:30 AM -- Forbidden City (故宫)

Arrive right at opening to beat the crowds. Enter through the south gate (Meridian Gate 午门), walk through the golden halls, and exit through the north gate (Gate of Divine Prowess 神武门). Don't miss the Imperial Garden (御花园) at the back -- ancient cypresses and rockeries make it the most romantic corner.

8:30-17:00 (Apr-Oct) / 8:30-16:30 (Nov-Mar) | ¥60 (Apr-Oct) / ¥40 (Nov-Mar) | ! Must book

online 7 days ahead via WeChat mini-program "故宫博物院"

11:00 AM -- Jingshan Park (景山公园)

Walk out the north gate of the Forbidden City and cross the street. Climb the hill (10 minutes) for the best panoramic view of the entire palace complex. The top pavilion is THE photo spot -- the golden roofs stretching out below you is unforgettable.

6:30-21:00 | ¥2

12:30 PM -- Lunch at Guijie Ghost Street (簋街)

Take a DiDi 10 minutes east. Guijie is Beijing's most famous food street -- 1km of restaurants lit up with red lanterns. The signature dish is spicy crayfish (麻辣小龙虾) -- messy, fun, and perfect for couples to share. Recommended: Hu Da (胡大饭馆), the most famous crayfish spot on the street.

11:00-次日6:00 (簋街很多店24小时营业) | ¥100-150/两人

2:30 PM -- Nanluoguxiang (南锣鼓巷)

A 800-year-old hutong alley turned into Beijing's most charming pedestrian street.

Browse quirky shops, grab bubble tea, and explore the side hutongs -- Yuer Hutong

(雨儿胡同) and Mao'er Hutong (帽儿胡同) are quieter and more authentic. Try the famous

文宇奶店 (Wenyu Dairy) for traditional Beijing yogurt.

全天开放, 店铺约10:00-22:00 | 免费入场

5:30 PM -- Houhai Lake (后海) Sunset & Evening

Walk west from Nanluoguxiang (15 minutes) to Houhai Lake. Rent a paddle boat (脚踏船)

and watch the sunset over the lake -- the willow trees, traditional houses, and golden

light make it incredibly romantic. After returning the boat, stroll along the bar street

(后海酒吧街). Recommended: 望海楼 (Wanghai Lou) for a quiet lakeside drink, or 烤肉季

(Rouji) for famous Beijing lamb BBQ since 1848.

全天开放 | 脚踏船 ¥60-80/小时 | 酒吧 18:00-次日2:00

Day 2: Great Wall & Date Night

8:00 AM -- Mutianyu Great Wall (慕田峪长城)

The most couple-friendly section of the Great Wall. Less crowded than Badaling, beautifully restored, and has a fun toboggan slide down. Take the cable car up to Tower 14, walk east to Tower 20 (best views, fewer people), then walk back and take the toboggan slide down from Tower 6. Allow 3-4 hours total.

Getting there:

Book a private car via DiDi (¥200-300 round trip, 1.5 hours) or take bus 916 Express from Dongzhimen Bus Station (东直门公交站) to Huairou, then transfer to bus H23 (total ¥15, 2 hours).

7:30-18:00 (Apr-Oct) / 8:00-17:00 (Nov-Mar) | ¥40 entry + ¥120 往返缆车 / ¥100 滑道下山

6:30 PM -- Date Night Dinner

Back in the city, dress up for a special dinner. Choose one:

* Dali Courtyard (大理院子)

* -- Hidden in a hutong near Nanluoguxiang. Yunnan cuisine in a candlelit courtyard with fairy lights. The grilled fish and wild mushroom hotpot are incredible. Intimate, romantic, and very "Beijing." Reserve 2 days ahead.

11:30-14:00, 17:30-22:00 | ¥150-200/两人 | 建议提前2天预约

* Capital M

* -- Fine dining at Qianmen with direct Tiananmen views through floor-to-ceiling windows. Western cuisine, excellent wine list. Perfect for anniversaries or proposals.

11:30-14:30, 18:00-22:30 | ¥400-600/两人 | 建议提前预约

9:30 PM -- Cocktails at Migas (米家思)

End the night at Beijing's best rooftop bar. On the 6th floor of Nali Patio in Sanlitun,

Migas has an open-air terrace with views over the neon-lit Taikoo Li complex. The

sangria and gin cocktails are excellent. On weekends, there's a DJ after 10 PM.

18:00-次日2:00 | ¥70-100/人/杯

Day 3: Culture, Food & Hidden Gems

8:00 AM -- Temple of Heaven (天坛)

More beautiful and less crowded than the Forbidden City. The Circular Mound Altar

(圜丘坛) is designed so sound echoes perfectly -- stand in the center and whisper to each

other, the acoustics are magical. Watch locals doing tai chi, dancing, and playing cards

in the long corridors.

6:00-21:00 | ¥15 (联票¥34含祈年殿/回音壁/圜丘)

11:30 AM -- Xiaolongbao at Din Tai Fung (鼎泰丰)

World-famous Taiwanese soup dumplings. Order the pork xiaolongbao (鲜肉小笼) and watch the chefs fold each one with 18 folds through the glass kitchen. The trick: bite a small hole, sip the soup, then dip in vinegar-ginger sauce. It's a fun shared experience.

11:00-21:30 | ¥100-150/两人

2:00 PM -- 798 Art District (798艺术区)

A massive former electronics factory complex turned into Beijing's coolest art zone. Wander through contemporary galleries, street art installations, and hipster cafes. Best spots for couples: UCCA Center for Contemporary Art (尤伦斯当代艺术中心), the graffiti walls, and the rooftop cafe at At Cafe. Great for Instagram photos.

10:00-17:00 (各画廊时间不同) | 免费入场, 个别展馆 ¥10-30

4:30 PM -- Traditional Tea at Wufu Tea House (五福茶艺馆)

After walking around 798, sit down for a proper Chinese tea ceremony. The staff will guide you through brewing oolong or pu'er tea in a gaiwan (盖碗). It's a calm, intimate experience -- perfect for slowing down together. Learn the "Gongfu" brewing method and taste 3-4 different teas.

9:30-21:00 | ¥80-150/两人 (含茶位费和茶点)

7:00 PM -- Sunset Cocktails at China World Summit Wing (国贸大酒店80层)

End the trip on the 80th floor of Beijing's tallest building. The Atmosphere Bar has floor-to-ceiling windows with a 360 deg view of the entire city -- the CBD skyline, the mountains in the west, and on clear days, the Great Wall in the distance. Arrive before sunset (around 6:30 PM in summer) to watch the city light up.

17:00-次日1:00 | ¥100-150/杯 | 建议穿Smart Casual

Couple's Tips:

* Best photo spots: Jingshan Park (Forbidden City view), Temple of Heaven echo wall,

Great Wall Tower 20, Houhai Lake sunset, 798 graffiti walls, 80th floor skyline

* Most romantic moments: Paddle boat on Houhai at sunset, whispering at the Temple

of Heaven echo wall, rooftop cocktails at Migas

* Budget: ¥600-800/天/两人 (经济) | ¥1500+/天/两人 (享受)

* 交通: 地铁 + 滴滴出行 | 办一张一卡通交通卡 (地铁站可买)

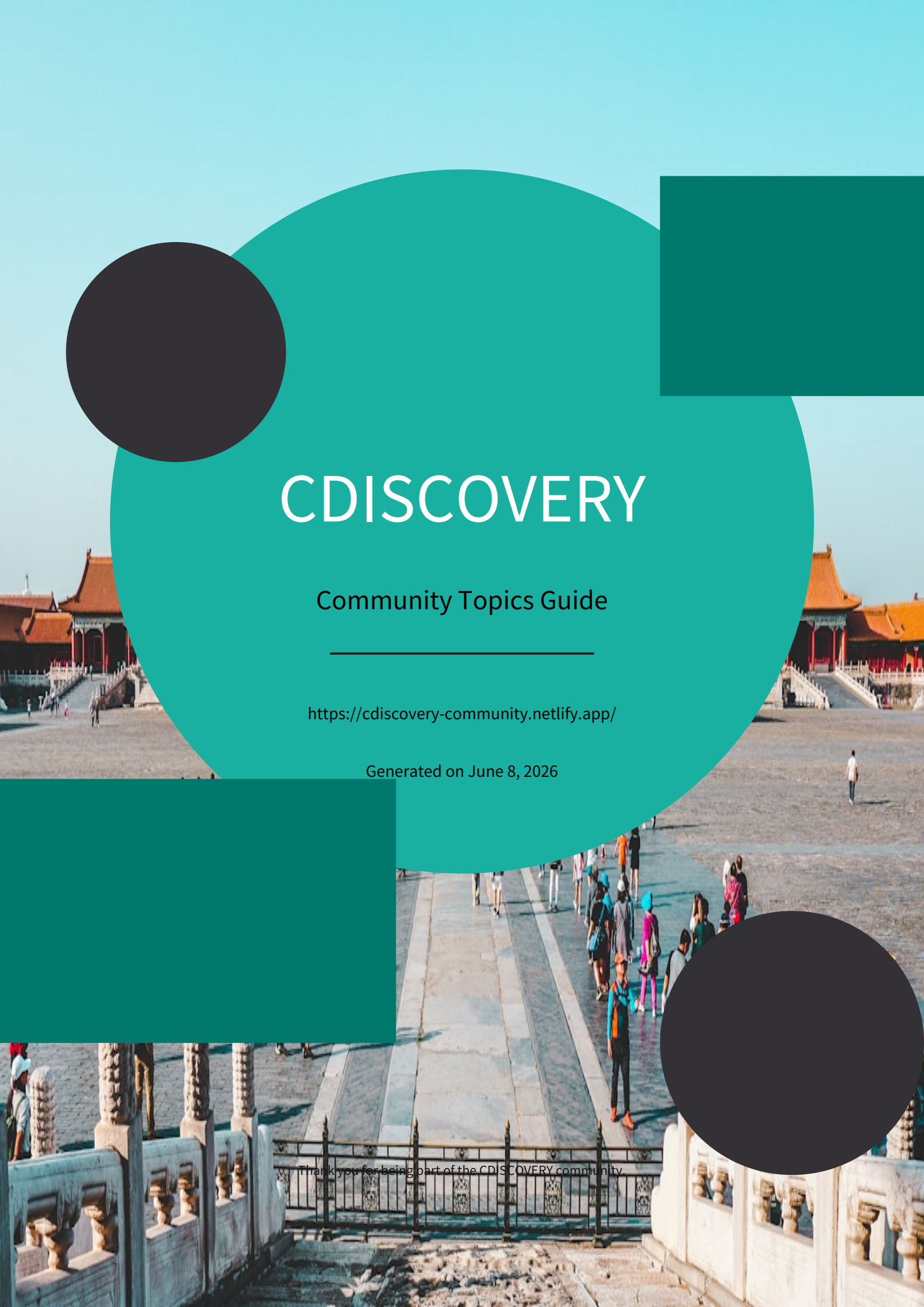
* 必备App: 大众点评 (找餐厅)、小红书 (找小众景点)、高德地图 (导航)

* 最佳季节: 春天4-5月 / 秋天9-10月 | 避开暑假 (7-8月太热) 和冬天 (12-2月太冷)

Sources: Sources: Community experiences • [The Beijinger](https://www.thebeijinger.com)

• [Trip.com](https://www.trip.com) • [高德地图](https://www.amap.com)

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